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Java SE 27 & JDK 27

Annotation Interface Target

```
@Documented
@Retention(RUNTIME)
@Target(ANNOTATION_TYPE)
public @interface Target
```

Indicates the contexts in which an annotation interface is applicable. The declaration contexts and type contexts in which an annotation interface may be applicable are specified in JLS §9.6.4.1, and denoted in source code by enum constants of `java.lang.annotation.ElementType`.

If an `@Target` meta-annotation is not present on an annotation interface `T`, then an annotation of type `T` may be written as a modifier for any declaration.

If an `@Target` meta-annotation is present, the compiler will enforce the usage restrictions indicated by `ElementType` enum constants, in line with JLS §9.7.4.

For example, this `@Target` meta-annotation indicates that the declared interface is itself a meta-annotation interface. It can only be used on annotation interface declarations:

```
@Target(ElementType.ANNOTATION_TYPE)
public @interface MetaAnnotationType {
    ...
}
```

This `@Target` meta-annotation indicates that the declared class or interface is intended solely for use as a member class or interface in complex annotation interface declarations. It cannot be used to annotate anything directly:

```
@Target({})
public @interface MemberInterface {
    ...
}
```

It is a compile-time error for a single `ElementType` constant to appear more than once in an `@Target` annotation. For example, the following `@Target` meta-annotation is illegal:

```
@Target({ElementType.FIELD, ElementType.METHOD, ElementType.FIELD})
public @interface Bogus {
    ...
}
```

See *Java Language Specification*:

9.6.4.1 @Target

9.7.4 Where Annotations May Appear

9.7.5 Multiple Annotations of the Same Interface

Since:

1.5

Required Element Summary

Required Elements

Modifier and Type	Required Element	Description
`ElementType[]`	**`value`**	Returns an array of the kinds of elements an annotation interface can be applied to.

Element Details

value

`ElementType[] value`

Returns an array of the kinds of elements an annotation interface can be applied to.

Returns:

an array of the kinds of elements an annotation interface can be applied to

---

Report a bug or suggest an enhancement
For further API reference and developer documentation see the Java SE Documentation, which contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples. Other versions.
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